



Jersey City Bitcoin Meetup #2

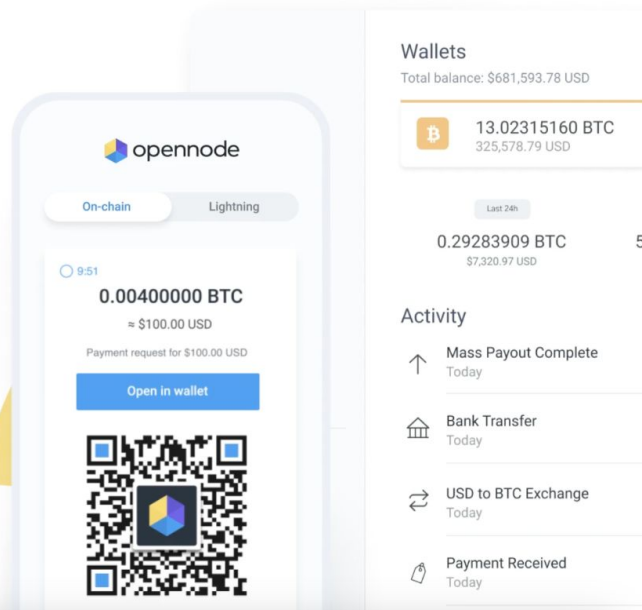
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Agenda:

- Intro
- Club Direction and 2026 Goals
- Mises Bitcoin Party
- Article Spotlight
- Bitcoin price update
- How to run a node



JC Bitcoin Meetup General Guidelines

- Basic Rules:

- Please no photos, no videos, no public tagging without consent!
- This group is Bitcoin only so please limit discussion of other cryptocurrencies.
- PLEASE respect the space. We love the barrow mansion and ask for help making it look better than when we arrived.
- For newcomers and OGs alike it is worth reiterating that absolutely no one from JC Bitcoin will ever solicit Bitcoin or crypto transfers here or on any other channel

JC Bitcoin Meetup

- You are all real ones, thanks for coming!
- Who are we?
 - We are the JC Bitcoin meetup! A space for formal discussions, seminars, and workshops for the Jersey city community
- Our Mission:
 - Create a Bitcoin education center in Jersey City
 - Empowering individuals and onboarding businesses to the bitcoin economy, and combating centralized control of money through grassroots activism
- Our Plan:
 - Educate our community, and train you! The bitcoin educators
 - Work with other US meetup organizers to open source our best practices and streamline local adoption all over the world
 - We will host these educational socratic meetups monthly, every 3rd Thursday of the month here at the Barrow Mansion
- How you can help
 - Tell your friends!
 - Join us and develop content



Club Direction Socratic Discussion

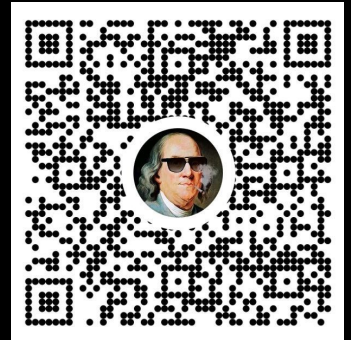
- Subscriptions/Donations
- Ideas?
- Volunteers to help plan / setup?
- Content team



Bitcoin
Subscription



Bitcoin
Donation



Venmo

Jersey City Bitcoin Meetup

Initiatives:

- Content team
- Filming/Broadcasting
- Sponsorships
- JC Orange Pilling
- Quarterly Bitcoin Meetup Meetups
- Street fairs
- Hands on workshops
- Getting Lyn Alden and Marty Bent to come

Rod Roudi

Rod Roudi

GM All -- we are putting together initial dates for our Park 2026 Sch...

Miles Suter from Block (Bitcoin Lead at CashApp/Square) is going to join us for Grassroots Bitcoin 2026 and give us all a behind the scenes look. Moreover, I want him to meet each of the meetup organizers in attendance and y'all develop a direct relationship (if you want) with him and Square to help with your own local Bitcoin grassroots efforts.



More to come 🤝

09:36



6



5



2

Jersey City Bitcoin Meetup

2026 Goals:

- [Fill this out with ideas]
- Open Node advertising sponsorship
- Skool - community/platform to host a content
 - Website manager? Content?
- Consistent meetings with content
- 2026 Vegas
- NJ/NYC Bitcoin Conference - have it at pubkey

Shoot for the Moon!

- Get Lyn Alden to come
- Some big event, bigger than a street fair
- Farmers markets
- Man on the street videos
- Colleges with bitcoin clubs - NJIT, Stevens, SHU,

Follow ups:

-

Club Direction Socratic Discussion

- Board Memberships
 - **Chair:** GC
 - **Marketing and Recruitment:**
 - **Website Manager:**
 - **Treasurer:** Jimmy
 - **Partnerships Manager:** (Harrison) (also working at Freedom Lab)
 - **Secretary:**
 - **Cypherpunks:**
 - Suggest content ideas, general contributor, helps maintain direction of the club

Mises Bitcoin Party

- State by state initiative, federal can be overturned
- Infiltrate Libertarian party with bitcoin perception, and creating a bitcoin party, run a bitcoin candidate in 2028, and have them drop out for concessions
- Pubkey Thomas is helping with the Big Bitcoin Ball at the National convention in Michigan, May 21st-24th
- Fill out the Bitcoin Movement form aka survey: <https://lpmc.us/btc>.
- Setting up calls, coordinate outreach and build a network of freedom-minded leaders



Article Spotlight

- [Arkade, Crypto, and Only The Strong Surviving](#)
 - By Allen Farrington
- TLDR:
 - We are entering the endgame of "Crypto" having any reason to exist.

Bitcoin Price Update:



Bitcoin Price Update:

- Risk off market
- Ai Bubble fears
- War, deflation, labor market turmoil
- But lil ol bitcoin is hodling strong
- Bear flag breakdown and rejection
- Expect continued weakness in the short term/coming weeks & months as the price continues to play out a bearish divergence amongst a weak macro outlook
- Y'all are legends for being here
- However QT ending, RMPs and continued stock market weakness are good signs liquidity injections could be on the horizon



Meme of the Month

Gloria Simping



Bugle.News   @bitcoin_bugle · Dec 15



We couldn't decide between a star or an angel, so we went with both





Running Your Own Bitcoin Node

James Tsetsekas
Jersey City Bitcoin

Nodes

- Who has heard of StartOS/Start9, Umbrel
- Who has a Node?
- Who has setup their node?
- Who is still using their node?
- My goal is to get more nodes in operation!

What is StartOS & Umbrel

- Android / iOS: operating systems for your phone
- Windows / MacOS / Linux: are operating systems for your computer ie laptop/ desktop
- Unix / Windows Server: Operating system for your servers
- StartOS & Umbrel are operating systems for a server but designed with an esy way to use graphical interface designed to make running services on a server as easy as running apps on your phone
- StartOS: is Free Open Source Software (FOSS)
- Umbrel: proprietary and source available. TL;DR — if you don't intend to sell Umbrel, our new license grants you the same freedoms that come with an open source license.
- Advantages of open source is because it open anyone can review the code for bugs etc.
- Anyone can contribute

dnyce@LinuxShellTips: ~

×

dnyce@LinuxShellTips: ~

×

dnyce@LinuxShellTips: ~

```
dnyce@LinuxShellTips:~$ script --t=timingfile.txt -a typescript.txt
Script started, output log file is 'typescript.txt', timing file is 'timingfile.txt'.
dnyce@LinuxShellTips:~$ ls
Desktop  Documents  Linuxshelltips  Pictures  RandNumGen.sh  Templates  typescript.txt
dir1     Downloads  Music           Public    snap           timingfile.txt  Videos
dnyce@LinuxShellTips:~$ cat RandNumGen.sh
#!/bin/bash
#LinuxShellTips Script to Generate a Random Number
RANDOM=$$
for i in RANDOM
do
    echo $RANDOM
done
dnyce@LinuxShellTips:~$ rm dir1
rm: cannot remove 'dir1': Is a directory
dnyce@LinuxShellTips:~$ rm -r dir1
dnyce@LinuxShellTips:~$
exit
Script done.
dnyce@LinuxShellTips:~$
```

PROBLEM



good morning, satoshi



Bitcoin Node



Lightning Node



Nostr Relay



Plex



Pi-hole



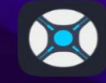
Home Assistant



Jellyfin



Transmission



Sonarr



Nextcloud

MANAGE APPS



SOLUTION

Start 9

Installed Services

start.local



Services



Marketplace



Updates



Notifications



System



Bitcoin Core

24.0.1

Running



Burn After Reading

0.1.5

Running



Embassy Pages

0.1.6

Running



Ghost

5.24.2

Running



Bitcoin Proxy

0.3.2-7

Running



Cups Messenger

0.3.8

Running



File Browser

2.22.4-1

Running



Specter

1.13.1

Running



Connected

SOLUTION

Why run a node?

- **Privacy:** Verify your transactions without relying on third parties
- **Security:** Ensure no one can fake your Bitcoin balance
- **Decentralization:** Strengthen Bitcoin by adding a full copy of the blockchain
- **Learning:** Deepen your understanding of Bitcoin and Lightning
- **Sovereignty:** Control your Bitcoin and Lightning transactions self-custodially with full independence

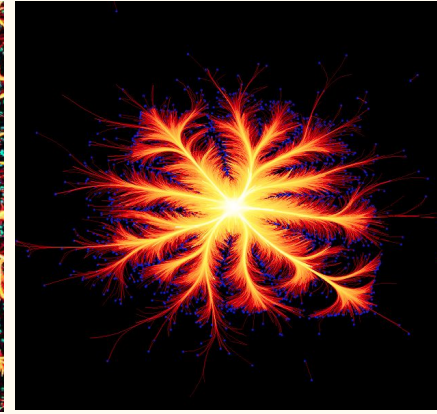
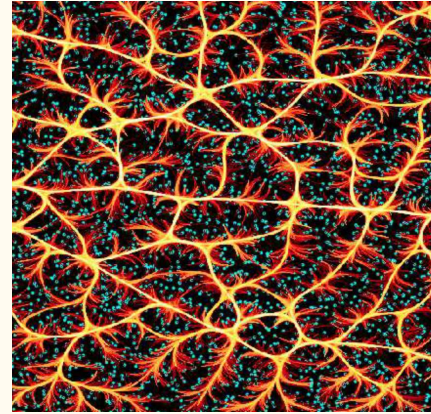
TAKE CONTROL OF YOUR DATA!



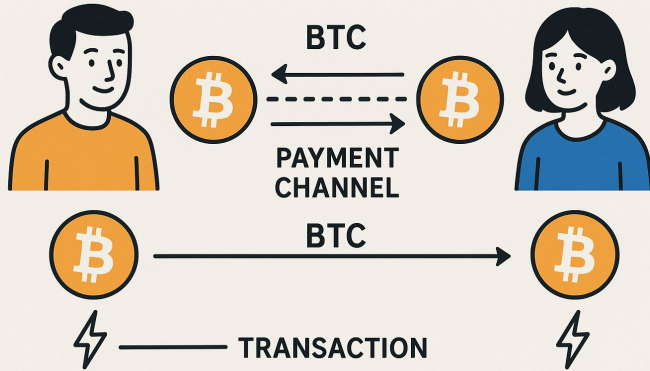
If Bitcoin is digital gold, a node is like a facility that tests and verifies its authenticity and chain of custody.

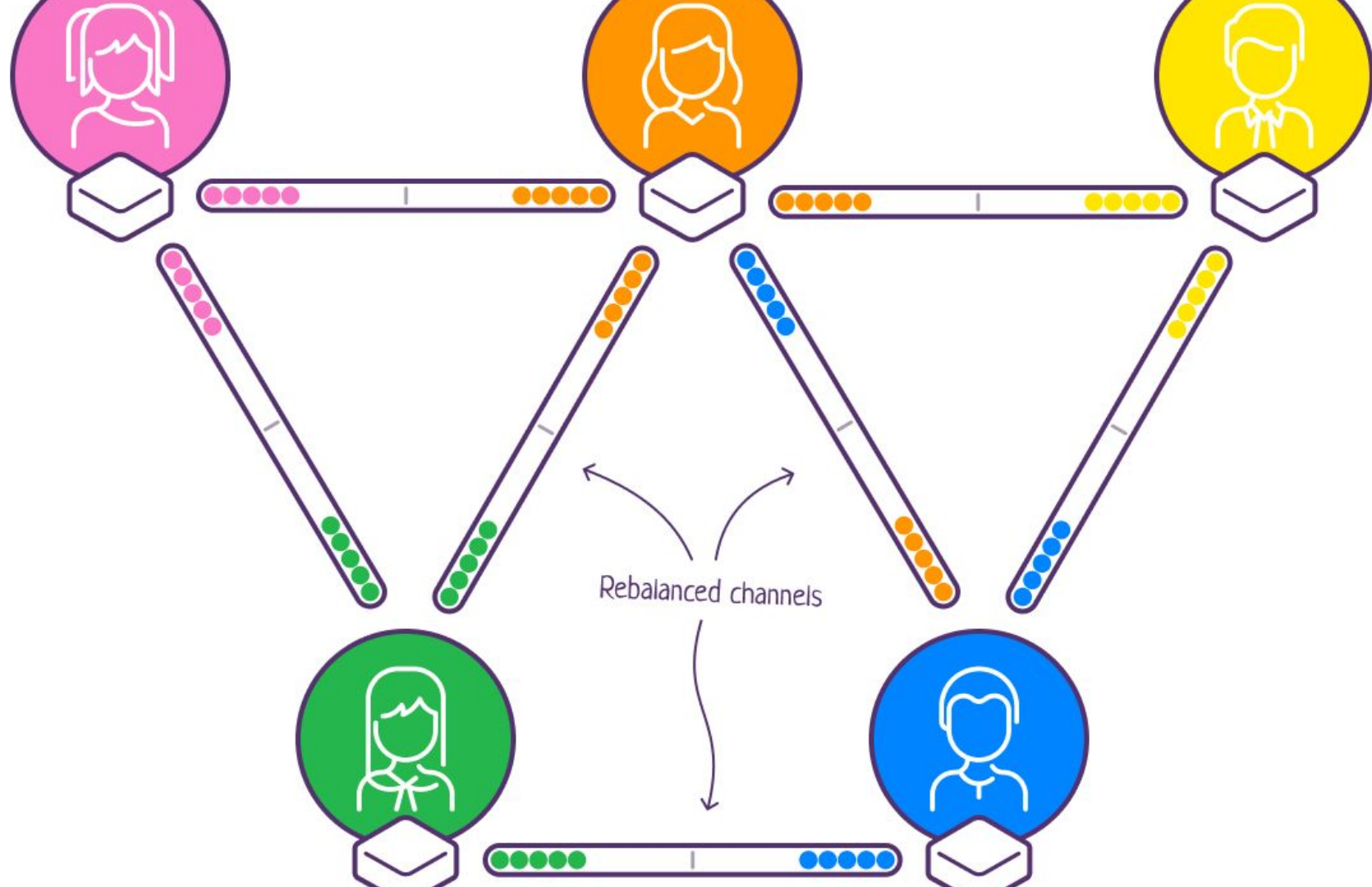
What is the Lightning Network

1. What It Is: A second layer on Bitcoin for fast, cheap transactions
2. Purpose: Solves Bitcoin's scalability by moving most transactions off-chain
3. Benefits: Near-instant payments, low fees, supports everyday use
4. Role of Nodes: Run your own node to manage Lightning channels and verify transactions



BITCOIN LIGHTNING NETWORK





Types of Nodes

- **Self-Hosted (DIY):** Build your own node with hardware like Raspberry Pi, or x86 ie N100 mini PC
- **Self-Hosted (Pre-Built):** Buy plug-and-play devices like Umbrel Home or Start9 Server
- **Cloud-Hosted:** Rent server space from providers like Voltage
- **Manual:** Run Bitcoin Core/Knots directly on a PC or laptop (battery backup)



Trade-off between cost, control, and convenience. DIY is cheapest but technical; pre-built is user-friendly; cloud sacrifices some sovereignty.

Self-Hosted: DIY Hardware

Hardware:

- Raspberry Pi 5 (8GB RAM recommended, ~\$80)
- 2TB SSD (~\$100) for blockchain storage
- Case, power supply, microSD card / USB boot drive (~\$50)

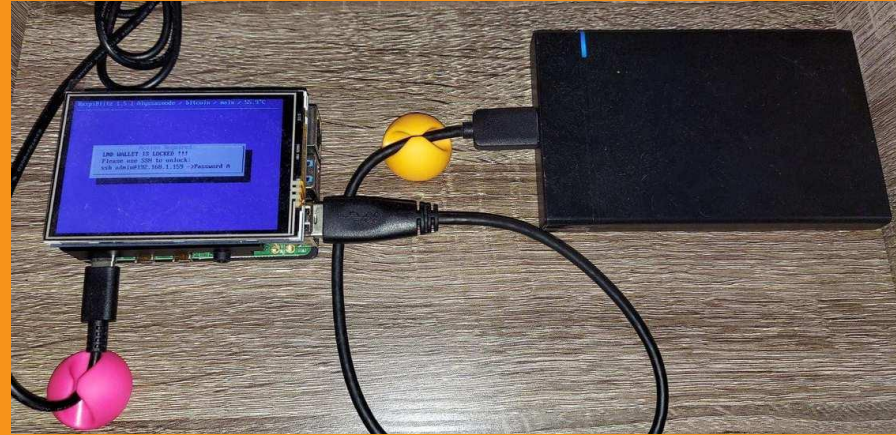
OR:

- x86 N100 Mini PC (e.g., Beelink, ~\$120-\$150)
- 2TB SSD (~\$100) for blockchain storage

Software Options:

- Umbrel: Beginner-friendly, app store, Docker-based
- Start9: Privacy-focused, stable, manual backups
- RaspiBlitz: Open-source, Lightning-centric, technical

Cost: ~\$200-\$300 total
internet + electricity



Self-Hosted: Pre-Built Hardware

- Umbrel Home (\$434): Intel N100, 16GB RAM, 2TB NVMe Plug-and-play, sleek UI, multi-purpose (e.g., Nextcloud)
- Start9 Server One (\$599): AMD Ryzen 7, 16GB RAM, 2TB NVMe Privacy-first, reliable, Tor by default
- Start9 Server Pure (\$999): Intel i7, 32GB RAM, premium build



Pros: Easy setup, robust hardware
Cons: Higher cost, less customizable

Cloud Hosting Options

Voltage: Managed Bitcoin and Lightning nodes in the cloud

Easy setup, no hardware needed

Ideal for businesses or low-maintenance users

Pros: No hardware maintenance, scalable, Try Free.

Cons: Less private, recurring costs(~\$25/month),
trust in provider

The logo for VOLTAGE, featuring the word "VOLTAGE" in a bold, black, sans-serif font. The letter "O" is stylized with a white lightning bolt symbol inside it. The logo is set against a white rectangular background.

Bitcoin Core vs. Bitcoin Knots

Bitcoin Core:

Official Bitcoin software, widely used

Rock-solid security, vanilla features

Supports pruning (less storage, ~5GB)

Bitcoin Knots:

Fork of Core, extra features (e.g. mempool tweaks)

Less contributors, less audited



LND (Lightning Network Daemon) vs. CLightning (Core Lightning)

- LND (Lightning Network Daemon):
 - Most popular Lightning implementation
 - Codebase: Go
 - Made by Lightning Labs <https://lightning.engineering/>
 - User-friendly, supports Umbrel, Start9, RaspiBlitz
 - Great for wallets like Zeus, Alby, and mobile apps
 - Active community with frequent updates as of December 2025
- Core Lightning (CLightning):
 - More modular, developer-focused, lighter resource use, less GUI support
 - Codebase: C and Rust
 - <https://corelightning.org/>
 - Offers advanced features like custom plugins and scripting
 - Preferred by developers for its flexibility and performance
 - Backed by Blockstream, with strong security focus
- Eclair:
 - Lightweight and mobile-friendly Lightning implementation
 - Codebase: Scala
 - Made by ACINQ <https://github.com/ACINQ/eclair>
 - Integrates with Phoenix wallet, ideal for Android/iOS
 - Known for fast sync and simplicity, popular in Europe
 - Open-source with active development in 2025



Other Software & Hardware

Free:

- RoninDojo: Privacy-focused, Samurai Wallet integration, no Lightning
- Nodl: Pre-built, supports BTCPay, ElectrumX, Samurai
- Manual (Core/Knots): Ultimate control, no UI, steep learning curve

Paid:

- MyNode: Clean UI, Bitcoin Core + LND, premium features (\$99)

Not “Real Nodes”

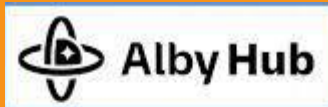
- Phoenix/PhoenixD: Lightweight, mobile-friendly, SPV-based nodes (Simplified Payment Verification)

Notes: MyNode is simpler but has paid tiers; RoninDojo is niche for privacy. Phoenix suits mobile users but isn't a full node. PhoenixD Phoenix for computers multiplatform.

Additional Software for Your Node

Payment & Commerce:

- BTCPay Server: Accept Bitcoin payments
- Alby Hub: Lightning wallet hub
- LNbits



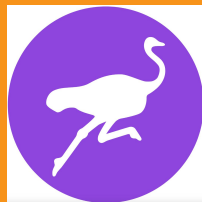
Lightning Management:

- Ride the Lightning, ThunderHub Channel management
- LNDg, Lightning Terminal: Advanced routing



Privacy & Wallets:

- ZeusLN: mobile Bitcoin/Lightning wallet and remote node manager for LND and Core Lightning
- Electrum Server: Connect wallets
- Cashu Wallets/Mints: Ecash for private microtransactions



Other:

- Nostr Relay: Decentralized social media
- Woofbot: Telegram notifications (price, watch tx, watch address, LN payment received, sent, channel open close)
- Notes: Highlight BTCPay for merchants, LNbits for flexibility. Warn about resource demands of extra apps, especially on Raspberry Pi.



Recommendations.

- 2TB NVMe SSD (\$100, 20+ years blockchain capacity)
- Stable internet, w/ no data caps
- UPS or Laptop for power outages
- Network security (e.g., strong router passwords). Disable UPnP

Do:

- Verify software downloads (e.g., PGP signatures)
- Back up Lightning channel states
- Start with a testnet to learn

Don't:

- Run too many apps on low-spec hardware ie Pi
- Ignore security (use Tor, firewalls)
- Expect profits from running a node

- Timeline: ~2-3 days to sync blockchain

Community support:

<https://community.umbrel.com/> Umbrel's community-driven model.
<https://community.start9.com/> Start9 Support: Dedicated team, forums for DIY users

Reddit: [r/Bitcoin](#), [r/raspiblit](#), [r/lightningnetwork](#)

Telegram: RaspiBlitz, Start9, Umbrel groups

GitHub: Report bugs, check updates (e.g., RaspiBlitz, Start9)

<https://lightningnetwork.plus/> Liquidity swaps allow multiple node operators to mutually open channels, benefiting all parties.

YouTube Tutorials:

- BTCSessions: Comprehensive Bitcoin guides
<https://www.youtube.com/@BTCSessions>
- Umbrel Tutorial: Using Bitcoin/Lightning Node
[\[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Fa9AvF4jk1o\]](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Fa9AvF4jk1o)
- Start9 Embassy: Node setup guide
[\[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DKBJ3_3ZomU\]](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DKBJ3_3ZomU)
- RaspiBlitz: Lightning and Bitcoin node
[\[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DTHlSPMz3ns\]](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DTHlSPMz3ns)

Websites:

- Bitcoiner Guide: Node comparisons [\[https://bitcoiner.guide\]](https://bitcoiner.guide)
- DARTHcoin Guides: Lightning software [\[https://darth-coin.github.io\]](https://darth-coin.github.io)
- <https://lightning.network/>

Additional Considerations

Topics to Include:

- **Lightning Risks:** Loss of funds is possible & Force closures possible (higher fees) need to monitor Lightning channels to avoid force-closures
- **Testnet Exploration:** Encourage using testnet3/testnet4 to practice without real funds. Umbrel's testnet4 support in 2025.
- **Not Recommended Pruning:** Explain Bitcoin Core's pruning option for low-storage devices (e.g., 5GB vs. 600GB+),
- **Watch Youtube Guides, Search and read community posts, seek help in community chat telegram etc (BEWARE OF SCAMMERS, DO NOT TRUST DMS chat in the open, never share private key)**
- **Use AI** provide context, logs, terminal outputs etc to get help with issues or commands.

Q&A and Closing

- Questions? Ask about setups, software, or resources!
- Key Takeaway: Running a node is empowering, affordable, and supports Bitcoin's ethos
- Get Started: Try Umbrel on a Pi 5 or explore Start9's free DIY software